



B. JOTHI RAMALINGAM

Sumit Nagal enters top 100 in ATP rankings



Sumit Nagal became the first Indian man in five years to make his Top 100 debut when the latest ATP Rankings were released on February 12. The 26-year-old broke the Top 100 barrier to No. 98 after beating Italy's Luca Nardi to win the Chennai Open title, an ATP Challenger Tour event. Before Nagal, the last Indian man to enter the Top 100 was Prajnesh Gunneswaran in 2019.

After a tough 2022 season, the Indian was ranked outside the Top 500 and needed a wildcard to even enter the qualifying round of the same event last year.

However, three titles and two runner-up finishes on the Challenger Tour in the last 12 months have helped him make the big jump.

"Every tennis player's dream is to at least be in the Top 100. The last few years have been tough with me being ranked 500, getting surgery done, and not having financial support. I'm very happy that I found a way to push every single day and gave myself a chance to be here," he said.

Sania Mirza is the only Indian woman to have ever made it to the Top 100 in the WTA Rankings. She achieved a career-high ranking of 27 in 2007.

NIHIT SACHDEVA

INDIAN PLAYGROUND

SPORTOON



SATISH
ACHARYA

1 India's Aditi Swami was awarded the **Breakthrough Archer of the Year 2023** award by World Archery.

At 17, Aditi became India's first-ever world champion in archery and also won gold in the women's team and an individual bronze medal at the Hangzhou Asian Games. Indian national compound team coach Sergio Pagni won the 'Best Coach of the Year' award. Under his guidance, India clean swept the medal tally at the Asian Games and won three world championship golds.

TEAM SPORTSTAR

2 Indian veteran paddler Sharath Kamal has outlined his post-2024 Paris Olympics plans. Confirming that the 2024 Olympics will mark his farewell, the 41-year-old is gearing up for a future role as an administrator or mentor. He has secured a position at the Tamil Nadu Physical and Education Sports University (TNPESU) in Melakottaiyur, Kancheepuram District. Sharath envisions this as a potential regional or national training center in the long run.

K. KEERTHIVASAN